driving force in preserving its integrity than the mercantile territorial European approach that appears to have seeped into Bharat's consciousness over time.

This subversion of the Indic perspective is equally reflected in the manner in which Bharat treats its geography on issues of development. The civilisational logic behind treatment of ecologically fragile or sensitive areas as sacred pilgrimage spots appears to have been completely lost on the 'modern' Indian State. This is because the State seems obsessed with 'religious tourism' and 'ecotourism', with diminishing respect for the fundamental matrix of nature, faith and patriotism that informs and makes this civilisation. Critically, this matrix includes respect for the rights of non-humans and their habitat. Bharat's civilisation is not one that reduces nature to just another branch of study, namely 'environmentalism', to be ticked off as just another box in an environmental impact assessment checklist. Instead, it puts nature right at the heart of its worldview and sees divinity in every aspect, form and manifestation of nature. From such lofty heights that directly affected ecological balance, and therefore survival, for this civilisation to now put development and nature in two different baskets with the former being treated as the priority, is the clearest reflection of the pervasion of colonial consciousness. Pointing this out may invite labels, such as 'tree hugger', 'luddite' or being 'anti-development', but all of these are terms typically used in the West, thereby exposing the coloniality even in the reactions. In other words, neither is the contemporary position on development indigenous nor is the response to those who oppose colonialised development. The absence of indigeneity could not have been starker.

In my opinion, this attitude is not limited to any particular dispensation, notwithstanding public professions of commitment to the consciousness of this land, the difference being only in intent and degree. While one dispensation may actively promote coloniality because it sees nothing of value in the past and has effectively surrendered indigenous agency at the feet of either or both colonialities, the other may see some value in native consciousness and yet suffer from unconscious coloniality. Also, the degree of coloniality varies in different spheres depending on exposure, exigency and expediency. That said, it would be unfair to draw false symmetries between dispensations because the dispensation and the establishment that presided over the formative years of independent Bharat must necessarily